

SECTION 1 — IMPORT-READY SOURCE FILE

AP World History: Modern Free-Response Practice Exam 3

APWH-SAQ3-001

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 1 — The Global Tapestry

Period: c. 1200–1450

Theme: GOV — Governance

Historical Reasoning: Mixed Historical Reasoning

Source Type: Secondary text source

Prompt:

Source 1: Historian Priya Raman, “Rule and Adaptation in the Delhi Sultanate,” modern historical interpretation, 2020.

“The Delhi Sultanate’s rulers did not simply impose a foreign political order on northern India. Their power depended on adaptation: using Persianate court culture, Islamic legal authority, military elites, and practical arrangements with local Hindu landholders and administrators.”

Source 2: Historian Marcus Bell, “Military States of Medieval Eurasia,” modern historical interpretation, 2017.

“The Delhi Sultanate should be understood primarily as a military state. Its rulers survived because they controlled cavalry forces, fortified cities, tax collection, and campaigns against rivals. Cultural accommodation mattered, but coercive power was the foundation of the sultanate’s authority.”

- (a) Identify one difference between the two historians’ interpretations of the Delhi Sultanate.
- (b) Describe one specific historical development that could be used to support one of the interpretations.
- (c) Explain one way the Delhi Sultanate was similar to or different from another state during c. 1200–1450.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Identifies a clear difference between the interpretations, such as Source 1 emphasizing adaptation and cooperation with local elites while Source 2 emphasizes military power, taxation, and coercion.
- (b) 1 point: Describes a relevant development, such as the use of Persianate administration, Islamic legitimacy, military slavery or cavalry forces, iqta-style revenue assignments, fortified cities, cooperation with Hindu landholders, or campaigns against rival kingdoms.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a valid similarity or difference with another state, such as the Mongol Khanates, Mali, the Mamluk Sultanate, Song China, or states in Southeast Asia, using specific evidence about military power, religion, bureaucracy, taxation, or elite cooperation.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should avoid describing the Delhi Sultanate as either only a religious state or only a military conquest regime. Strong responses should show how political authority could depend on both force and adaptation. For part (c), the best answers name another state and compare a specific method of rule rather than making a vague statement about “strong governments.”

Expected Points:

3

APWH-SAQ3-002

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 3 — Land-Based Empires

Period: c. 1450–1750

Theme: CDI — Cultural Developments and Interactions

Historical Reasoning: Sourcing / POV / Purpose / Audience

Source Type: Primary text source

Prompt:

Source: Letter from a Mughal court official to a provincial revenue administrator, Agra, 1583. This excerpt is original but modeled on the style of Mughal administrative correspondence during Akbar’s reign.

“The emperor desires that assessment be made with fairness so that the cultivator may return to his field without fear. In districts where Rajput chiefs have entered imperial service, their honors must be respected, provided that they collect revenue according to regulation and provide soldiers when required. Let no official disturb temples, mosques, or shrines without cause, for disorder in matters of faith harms the peace of the realm. The strength of the empire lies not only in conquest but in making many peoples useful to one order.”

(a) Identify the likely purpose of the letter.

(b) Explain how the letter reflects one method used by the Mughal Empire to govern a diverse population.

(c) Explain one limitation of the letter as evidence for the experiences of ordinary people under Mughal rule.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

(a) 1 point: Identifies a plausible purpose, such as instructing a provincial official to collect revenue fairly, maintain order, cooperate with Rajput elites, respect local religious institutions, or strengthen imperial authority.

(b) 1 point: Explains a relevant Mughal method of rule, such as incorporating local elites, using revenue administration, practicing religious accommodation under Akbar, maintaining military obligations, or balancing conquest with negotiated loyalty.

(c) 1 point: Explains a valid limitation, such as the letter representing the perspective of imperial officials rather than peasants, women, artisans, religious minorities, or rebellious groups; or noting that official policy may not reflect actual local conditions.

Model Guidance:

A strong response should use the source’s perspective as an imperial administrative document. The letter presents Mughal rule as orderly and inclusive because it is written by an official trying to guide provincial governance. Strong answers should connect the source to broader Mughal strategies without assuming that official ideals always matched the lived experiences of ordinary people.

Expected Points:

3

APWH-SAQ3-003

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 5 — Revolutions

Period: c. 1750–1900

Theme: TEC — Technology and Innovation

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Non-text source

Prompt:

Source: Description of a Japanese woodblock print produced in Tokyo, c. 1875.

The print shows a newly built schoolroom with glass windows, desks, a wall clock, and a large map of the world. Boys and girls sit in rows while a teacher points to a chart showing steamships, telegraph wires, and a railway engine. Outside the window, a uniformed official stands near a street with gas lamps and Western-style brick buildings. A caption reads: “Learning for a Strong Country.”

- (a) Identify one reform goal suggested by the described print.
- (b) Explain one way the Meiji Restoration contributed to the reform goal shown in the print.
- (c) Explain one way Japanese reform efforts during the late nineteenth century were similar to or different from reform efforts in another state during c. 1750–1900.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Identifies a valid reform goal, such as expanding modern education, strengthening the state, promoting industrialization, adopting Western technology, training citizens, or building national power.
- (b) 1 point: Explains how the Meiji Restoration contributed to reform, such as centralizing authority, ending many samurai privileges, promoting state-led industrialization, building railways, adopting Western military and educational models, or revising institutions to resist imperial domination.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a valid similarity or difference with another reforming state, such as the Ottoman Empire, Qing China, Russia, or Egypt, using specific evidence about military reform, industrialization, education, constitutionalism, state centralization, or responses to foreign pressure.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should interpret the visual details as evidence of state-directed modernization. The schoolroom, world map, technology chart, official, and slogan all point to the link between education, technology, and national strength. Strong comparisons should explain why reform programs emerged and how they differed in success, scope, or political context.

Expected Points:

3

APWH-DBQ3-001

Section: DBQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 9 — Globalization

Period: c. 1900–present

Theme: ENV — Humans and the Environment

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Seven-document set

Prompt:

Evaluate the extent to which environmental problems encouraged new forms of global cooperation and conflict from c. 1970 to 2000.

Document 1

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Statement by a delegate from Sweden at an international environmental conference, 1972, Stockholm.

Source Type: Conference statement.

“Smoke, poisoned rivers, and chemical waste do not stop at national borders. Industrial progress has improved human life, but it has also created dangers that no country can manage alone. We must develop shared standards, scientific monitoring, and international agreements so that economic growth does not destroy the conditions of life itself.”

Sourcing cues: Delegate from an industrialized country hosting an environmental conference; emphasizes transnational regulation and scientific cooperation.

Document 2

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Speech by a delegate from India at the same international conference, 1972, Stockholm.

Source Type: Conference speech.

“We are asked to limit pollution, but many nations making these requests became wealthy through centuries of industrial use of coal, forests, minerals, and colonial resources. Poverty is also an environmental danger. A village without clean water, fuel, or land suffers as surely as a city with polluted air. Environmental policy must not become a tool by which the wealthy deny development to the poor.”

Sourcing cues: Representative of a developing country; links environmental policy to inequality, development, and postcolonial concerns.

Document 3

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Environmental monitoring summary, international scientific panel, 1985.

Source Type: Plain-text data table.

Selected Atmospheric Measurements, 1970–1985

Year	Average Measured CFC Concentration	Reported Ozone Layer Concern
1970	Low but rising	Limited public concern
1975	Higher	Scientific debate increasing
1980	Much higher	Growing concern over ozone depletion
1985	Sharp increase documented	Major concern after Antarctic ozone data

Note on the table: CFCs were widely used in refrigeration, aerosol sprays, and industrial processes. Scientists warned that ozone depletion could increase harmful ultraviolet radiation.

Sourcing cues: Scientific panel data; useful for showing environmental problems identified through international research.

Document 4

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Statement by executives of a chemical manufacturing association, 1987, London.

Source Type: Industry statement.

“Industry recognizes public concern about the ozone layer, but sudden bans on widely used chemicals would harm refrigeration, medicine storage, food transport, and employment. Any transition must be gradual, scientifically verified, and economically realistic. Governments should avoid measures that punish responsible producers while rewarding competitors who ignore regulations.”

Sourcing cues: Industry perspective; acknowledges environmental concerns but prioritizes economic costs, jobs, and regulation timing.

Document 5

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Description of an environmental activist poster, 1988, Toronto.

Source Type: Described poster.

The poster shows Earth as a blue sphere under a cracked transparent shield. Around the planet are drawings of aerosol cans, refrigerators, factories, and children wearing wide-brimmed hats under a bright sun. At the bottom, a slogan reads: “One Atmosphere, One Future: Ban Ozone-Destroying Chemicals.”

Sourcing cues: Activist visual source; uses emotional imagery and global symbolism to encourage public support for regulation.

Document 6

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Excerpt from a treaty summary distributed by an international organization, 1990.

Source Type: Treaty summary.

“Member states agree to phase down the production and consumption of substances identified as damaging to the ozone layer. Industrialized countries shall begin reductions earlier. A financial mechanism will assist developing countries in obtaining substitute technologies. Scientific review panels will recommend future adjustments as evidence changes.”

Sourcing cues: International organization summary; reflects negotiated compromise between environmental goals, scientific expertise, and development concerns.

Document 7

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Interview with a Brazilian environmental official after debates over Amazon deforestation, 1992, Rio de Janeiro.

Source Type: Interview excerpt.

“Foreign governments speak of the forest as if it belongs to humanity in general, but it lies within our national territory. We accept the need to protect biodiversity and indigenous communities, yet we cannot ignore roads, farms, minerals, and jobs. Cooperation is welcome when it respects sovereignty. Pressure without resources will be seen as interference.”

Sourcing cues: Government official from a country with major rainforest resources; emphasizes sovereignty, development, conservation, and international pressure.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 7

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point by making a historically defensible claim that evaluates the extent to which environmental problems encouraged global cooperation and conflict from c. 1970 to 2000. A strong thesis should establish a line of reasoning, such as arguing that environmental problems created new institutions and treaties but also intensified conflicts over development, sovereignty, and economic responsibility.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing a broader historical context relevant to global environmental politics, such as postwar industrial growth, decolonization, the rise of international organizations, scientific monitoring, consumer society, Cold War-era global conferences, globalization of production, or growing public activism.

Evidence from the Documents — 2 points: Earns 1 point by accurately using the content of at least three documents to address the prompt. Earns 2 points by using at least six documents to support an argument about environmental cooperation, scientific research, treaty-making, activism, industry resistance, development concerns, or sovereignty conflicts.

Evidence Beyond the Documents — 1 point: Earns the point by using at least one specific piece of relevant outside evidence not found in the documents, such as the creation of the United Nations Environment Programme, the Montreal Protocol, Earth Day, the Chernobyl disaster, Bhopal disaster, Green parties, climate change negotiations, the Kyoto Protocol, biodiversity agreements, or debates over sustainable development.

Sourcing / Analysis of Documents — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining how or why the point of view, purpose, audience, or historical situation of at least three documents is relevant to the argument. Effective examples include explaining why developing-country delegates emphasized poverty and inequality, why industry groups warned against sudden bans, why activists used emotional global imagery, or why governments with rainforests emphasized sovereignty.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by demonstrating a more complex understanding of environmental politics. This may include explaining that environmental problems were global in physical effect but unequal in responsibility and capacity, that science encouraged cooperation while economic interests produced conflict, or that environmental agreements required compromises between industrialized and developing states.

Model Guidance:

A strong DBQ could argue that environmental problems encouraged new forms of global cooperation through scientific monitoring, conferences, treaties, and financial mechanisms, but also produced conflict over development, industrial costs, sovereignty, and historical responsibility.

Documents 1, 3, 5, and 6 can support arguments about scientific and institutional cooperation.

Documents 2, 4, and 7 can support arguments about conflict over economic inequality, regulation, and national sovereignty. Outside evidence might include the Montreal Protocol, UNEP, Earth Day, Bhopal, Chernobyl, the Kyoto Protocol, or sustainable development debates. Strong sourcing could analyze the contrasting perspectives of industrialized states, developing countries, industry groups, activists, and resource-rich governments.

Expected Points:

7

APWH-LEQ3-001

Section: LEQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 7 — Global Conflict

Period: c. 1900–present

Theme: GOV — Governance

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Broad historical prompt with introductory statement

Prompt:

In the decades after World War I, several states experienced political instability, economic crisis, mass mobilization, and challenges to liberal parliamentary systems. In some cases, authoritarian movements promised national revival, social order, territorial expansion, or protection from communism and capitalism.

Evaluate the extent to which economic crises contributed to the rise of authoritarian states in the period c. 1918 to 1939.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 6

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point by making a historically defensible claim that evaluates the extent to which economic crises contributed to the rise of authoritarian states from c. 1918 to 1939. A strong thesis should establish a line of reasoning that weighs economic causes against political, social, ideological, or international factors.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing a broader context relevant to the interwar period, such as the effects of World War I, the Treaty of Versailles, the Russian Revolution, the Great Depression, mass politics, fears of communism, nationalist resentment, imperial ambitions, or weaknesses of parliamentary governments.

Evidence — 2 points: Earns 1 point by identifying at least two specific pieces of relevant evidence, such as the Great Depression, hyperinflation in Germany, unemployment, the Nazi Party, Mussolini's Fascist movement, Stalin's command economy, Japanese militarism, the Weimar Republic, reparations, or fear of socialist revolution. Earns 2 points by using at least two pieces of evidence to support an argument about causation.

Historical Reasoning — 1 point: Earns the point by using causation to explain how economic crises contributed to authoritarianism and how other causes also mattered. Strong responses might explain that economic distress weakened confidence in liberal institutions, expanded support for extremist movements, or allowed leaders to promise stability, while also showing the role of war memory, nationalism, ideology, and political violence.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by demonstrating a nuanced understanding of interwar authoritarianism. This may include comparing different states, showing that economic crisis was more important in some cases than others, explaining interaction between economic and ideological causes, or distinguishing between fascist, communist, and militarist forms of authoritarian rule.

Model Guidance:

A strong LEQ should make a clear causal argument rather than simply listing authoritarian leaders. Useful evidence could include the Great Depression, German hyperinflation, Weimar instability, Nazi promises of jobs and national revival, Mussolini's use of nationalism and anti-socialism, Stalin's command economy, Japanese military influence, and fears of communism. Strong answers should weigh economic crisis against other causes such as World War I, nationalist humiliation, weak democratic institutions, political violence, and ideological mobilization.

Expected Points:

6

SECTION 2 — SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — DO NOT IMPORT

SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — APWH-FRQ3

· APWH-SAQ3-001: Unit 1 — The Global Tapestry; c. 1200–1450; South Asia / Delhi Sultanate with possible comparison to Mongol Khanates, Mali, Mamluk Sultanate, Song China, or Southeast Asian states; secondary text source with two modern historians; source perspectives contrast adaptation through Persianate culture, Islamic authority, and local Hindu elites with military coercion, cavalry, fortifications, and taxation; historical development is Delhi Sultanate state

formation and governance; reasoning path analyzes competing interpretations of political authority and compares state-building methods; misconception targeted: the Delhi Sultanate ruled only through religion or only through conquest without local adaptation.

· APWH-SAQ3-002: Unit 3 — Land-Based Empires; c. 1450–1750; South Asia / Mughal Empire under Akbar; primary text source is an original imperial administrative letter to a provincial revenue official; source perspective is Mughal court administration emphasizing revenue fairness, Rajput incorporation, religious accommodation, and imperial order; historical development is Mughal governance of diversity through elite incorporation, revenue systems, military obligations, and religious policy; reasoning path focuses on purpose, imperial administration, and source limitations; misconception targeted: Mughal rule over diversity depended only on tolerance or only on conquest.

· APWH-SAQ3-003: Unit 5 — Revolutions; c. 1750–1900; East Asia / Meiji Japan; non-text source type is a described Japanese woodblock print of a modern schoolroom; visual/data/map pattern includes school desks, world map, steamship, telegraph, railway chart, official, gas lamps, and Western-style buildings; historical development is Meiji state-led modernization, education reform, technology adoption, and national strengthening; reasoning path is causation from restoration reforms to modernization goals and comparison with other reforming states; misconception targeted: Meiji reforms were simple Western imitation rather than state-directed modernization for sovereignty and power.

· APWH-DBQ3-001: Unit 9 — Globalization; c. 1900–present; global environmental politics involving Sweden, India, international scientific panels, chemical manufacturers, Canadian activists, international treaty organizations, and Brazil/Amazon debates; DBQ topic is environmental problems encouraging global cooperation and conflict from c. 1970 to 2000; document types include conference statement, developing-country speech, scientific data table, industry statement, described activist poster, treaty summary, and government interview; document perspectives include industrialized-state delegates, developing-country representatives, scientists, industry executives, activists, international organizations, and resource-sovereignty officials; main argument paths include transnational pollution, scientific monitoring, ozone depletion, treaty-making, financial mechanisms, industry resistance, development inequality, sovereignty, and conservation conflict; outside evidence possibilities include UNEP, Montreal Protocol, Earth Day, Bhopal, Chernobyl, Green parties, Kyoto Protocol, biodiversity agreements, and sustainable development; sourcing opportunities include industrialized versus developing-country perspectives, industry economic interests, activist emotional appeals, treaty compromise, and sovereignty claims over rainforest resources.

· APWH-LEQ3-001: Unit 7 — Global Conflict; c. 1900–present; interwar Europe and East Asia with possible evidence from Germany, Italy, Soviet Union, Japan, and broader global depression effects; LEQ topic is economic crises and the rise of authoritarian states from c. 1918 to 1939; historical reasoning process is causation; evidence categories include Great Depression, hyperinflation, unemployment, Weimar instability, Nazi Party, Mussolini's Fascism, Stalin's command economy, Japanese militarism, reparations, fear of communism, mass politics, and political violence; complexity path weighs economic crisis against World War I legacies, nationalist resentment, ideology, weak parliamentary systems, anti-communism, and militarism; misconception targeted: authoritarianism rose only because of the Great Depression or only because of dictators' personal ambitions.